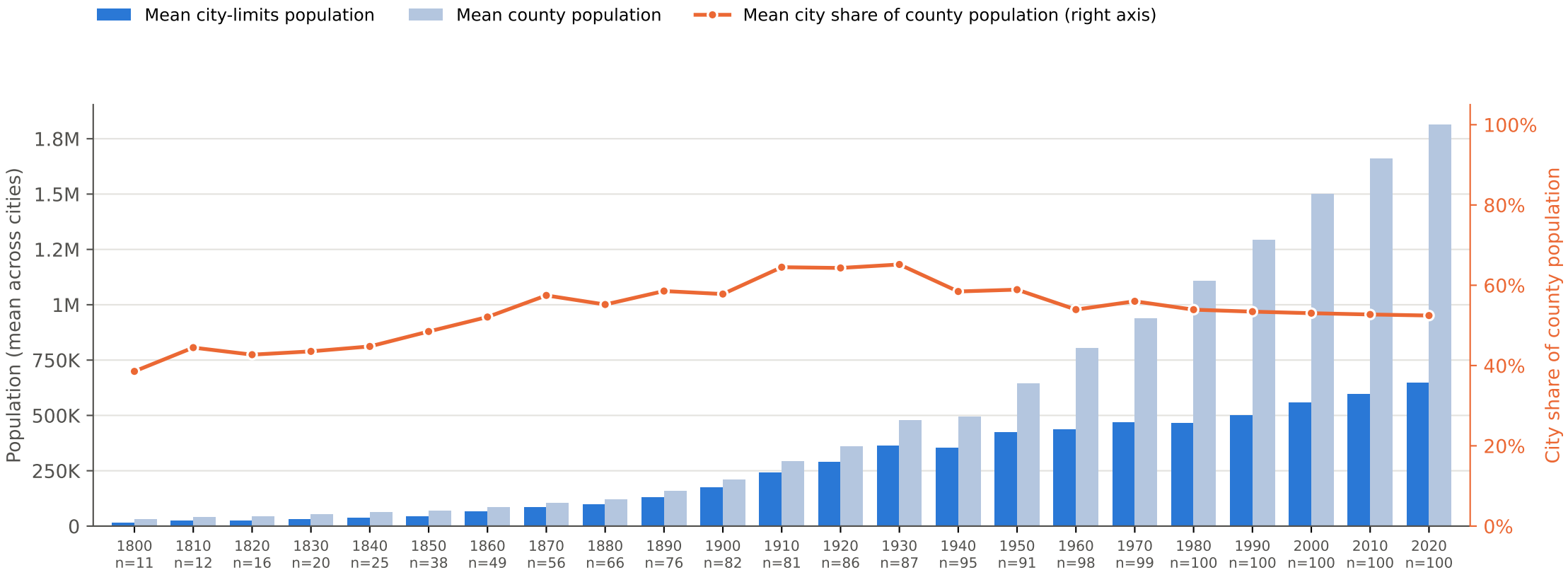
All cities average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (unweighted)

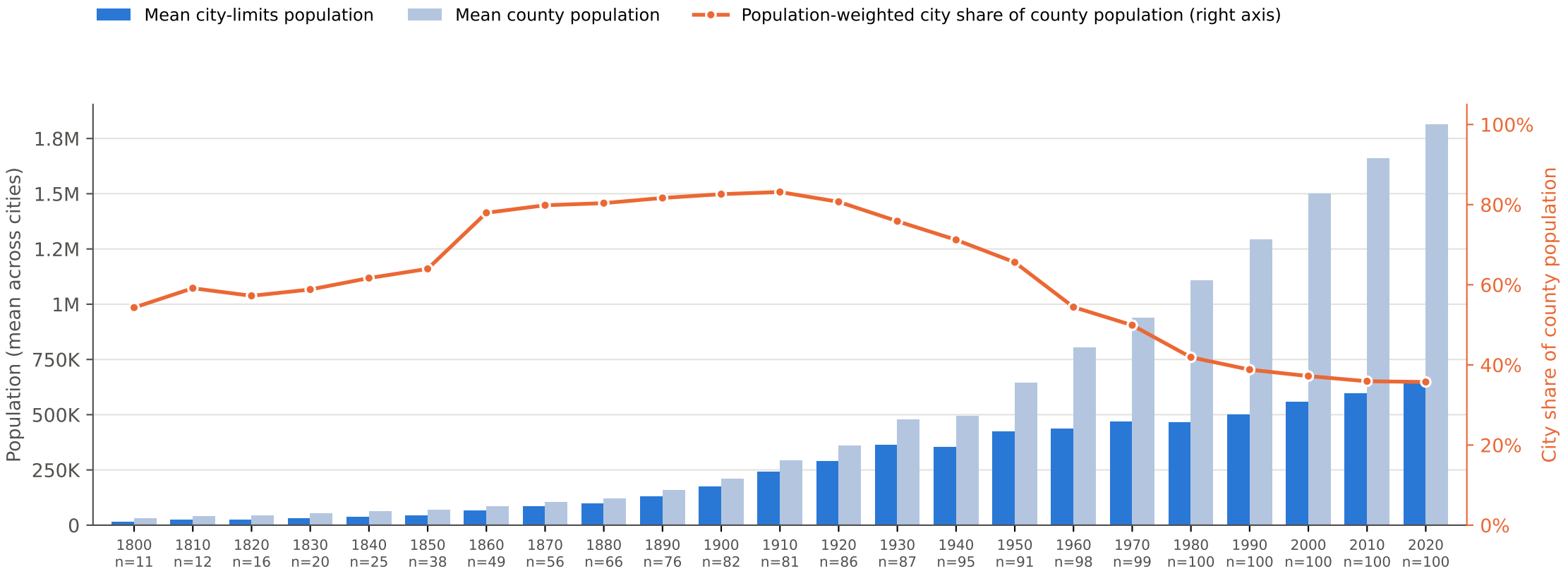
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), all 100 cities. Line: simple mean of city shares.



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
Quartiles use 2020 land area for every year: they group cities by today's size, not their size at the time (many cities grew by annexation).
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

All cities average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (population-weighted)

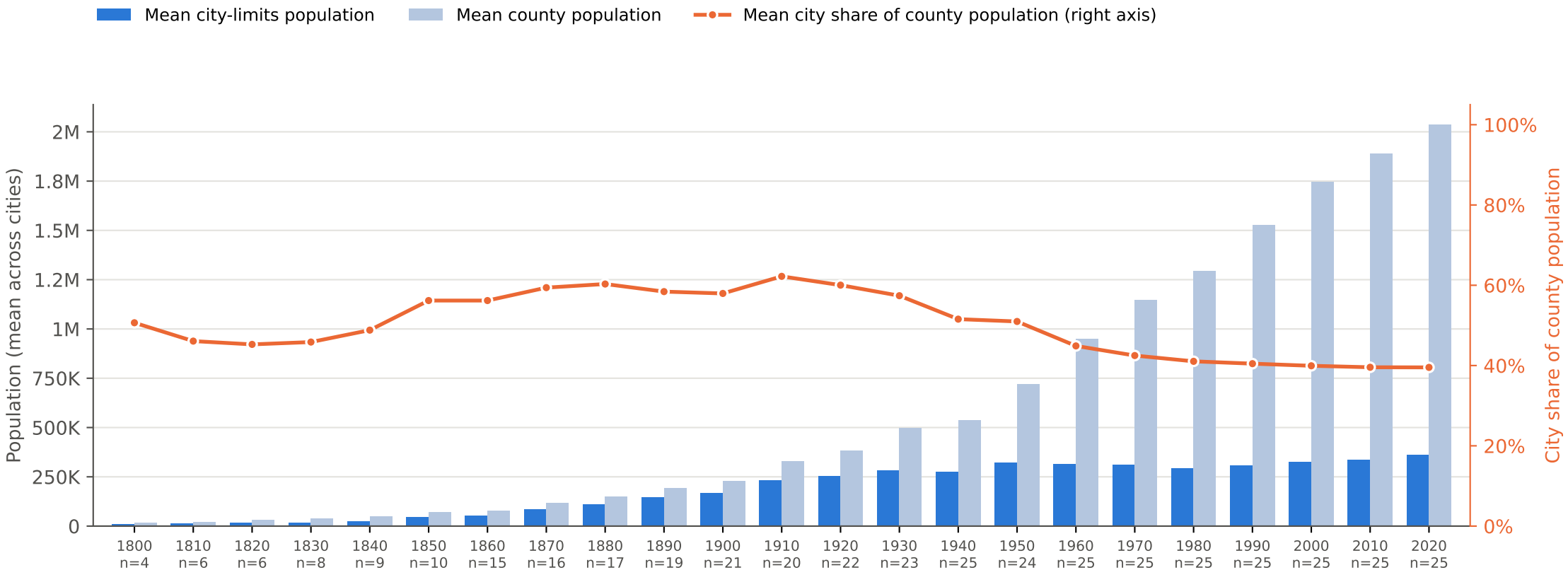
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), all 100 cities. Line: total city pop. ÷ total county pop. (ratio of the bars).



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
New York's comparison area is its five boroughs (share 100%), and its size dominates this population-weighted average from 1900 on.
Quartiles use 2020 land area for every year: they group cities by today's size, not their size at the time (many cities grew by annexation).
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

Land-area Q1 (smallest) average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (unweighted)

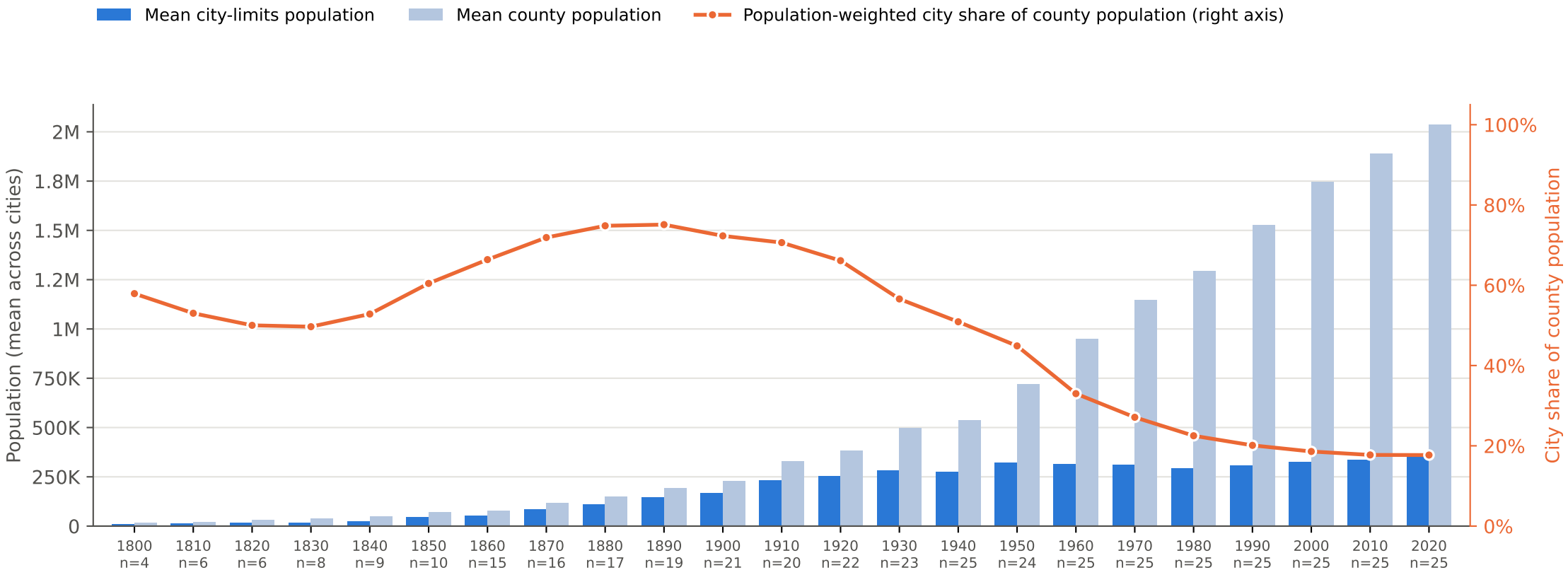
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), 25 cities with 2020 land area 14.7–65.3 sq mi. Line: simple mean of city shares.



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
Quartiles use 2020 land area for every year: they group cities by today's size, not their size at the time (many cities grew by annexation).
Land-area Q1 (smallest): San Francisco, CA, Washington, DC, Boston, MA, Long Beach, CA, Miami, FL, Oakland, CA, Minneapolis, MN, Anaheim, CA, Stockton, CA, Newark, NJ, St. Paul, MN, Santa Ana, CA, Pittsburgh, PA, St. Louis, MO, Jersey City, NJ, Buffalo, NY, Chandler, AZ, Chula Vista, CA, St. Petersburg, FL, Glendale, AZ, Garland, TX, Norfolk, VA, Richmond, VA, Hialeah, FL, San Bernardino, CA.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

Land-area Q1 (smallest) average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (population-weighted

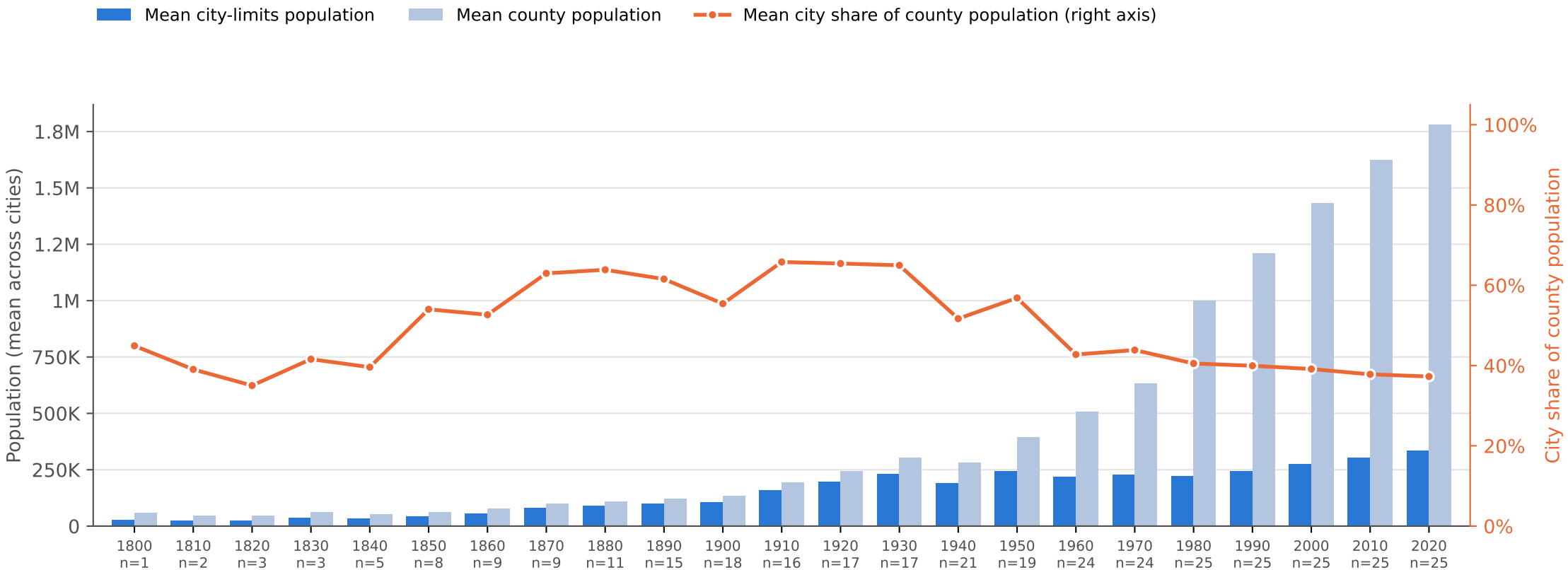
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), 25 cities with 2020 land area 14.7–65.3 sq mi. Line: total city pop. ÷ total county pop. (ratio of the bars).



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
Quartiles use 2020 land area for every year: they group cities by today's size, not their size at the time (many cities grew by annexation).
Land-area Q1 (smallest): San Francisco, CA, Washington, DC, Boston, MA, Long Beach, CA, Miami, FL, Oakland, CA, Minneapolis, MN, Anaheim, CA, Stockton, CA, Newark, NJ, St. Paul, MN, Santa Ana, CA, Pittsburgh, PA, St. Louis, MO, Jersey City, NJ, Buffalo, NY, Chandler, AZ, Chula Vista, CA, St. Petersburg, FL, Glendale, AZ, Garland, TX, Norfolk, VA, Richmond, VA, Hialeah, FL, San Bernardino, CA.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

Land-area Q2 average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (unweighted)

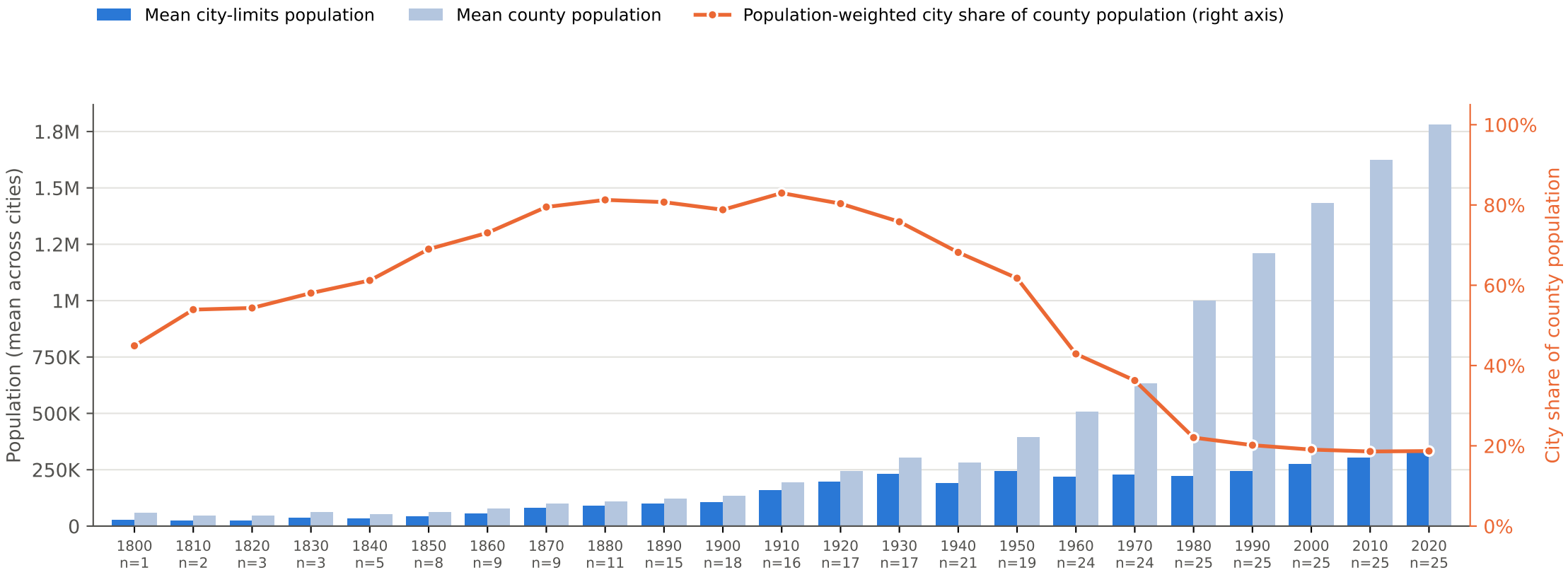
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), 25 cities with 2020 land area 65.6–110.6 sq mi. Line: simple mean of city shares.



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
Quartiles use 2020 land area for every year: they group cities by today's size, not their size at the time (many cities grew by annexation).
Land-area Q2: Seattle, WA, Baltimore, MD, Milwaukee, WI, Sacramento, CA, Arlington, TX, Cleveland, OH, Henderson, NV, Riverside, CA, Cincinnati, OH, Irvine, CA, Orlando, FL, Lincoln, NE, Plano, TX, Toledo, OH, Madison, WI, Gilbert, AZ, Reno, NV, North Las Vegas, NV, Irving, TX, Laredo, TX, Boise, ID, Fremont, CA, Spokane, WA, Santa Clarita, CA, Baton Rouge, LA.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

Land-area Q2 average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (population-weighted)

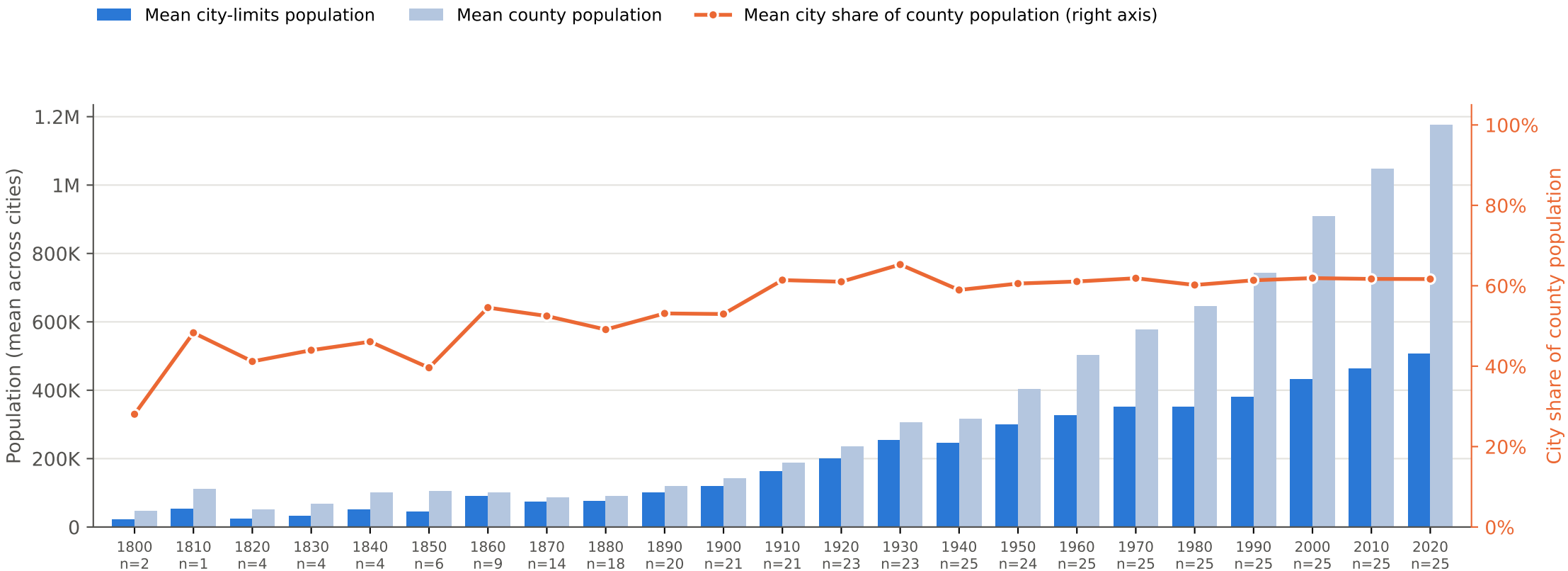
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), 25 cities with 2020 land area 65.6–110.6 sq mi. Line: total city pop. ÷ total county pop. (ratio of the bars).



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
Quartiles use 2020 land area for every year: they group cities by today's size, not their size at the time (many cities grew by annexation).
Land-area Q2: Seattle, WA, Baltimore, MD, Milwaukee, WI, Sacramento, CA, Arlington, TX, Cleveland, OH, Henderson, NV, Riverside, CA, Cincinnati, OH, Irvine, CA, Orlando, FL, Lincoln, NE, Plano, TX, Toledo, OH, Madison, WI, Gilbert, AZ, Reno, NV, North Las Vegas, NV, Irving, TX, Laredo, TX, Boise, ID, Fremont, CA, Spokane, WA, Santa Clarita, CA, Baton Rouge, LA.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

Land-area Q3 average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (unweighted)

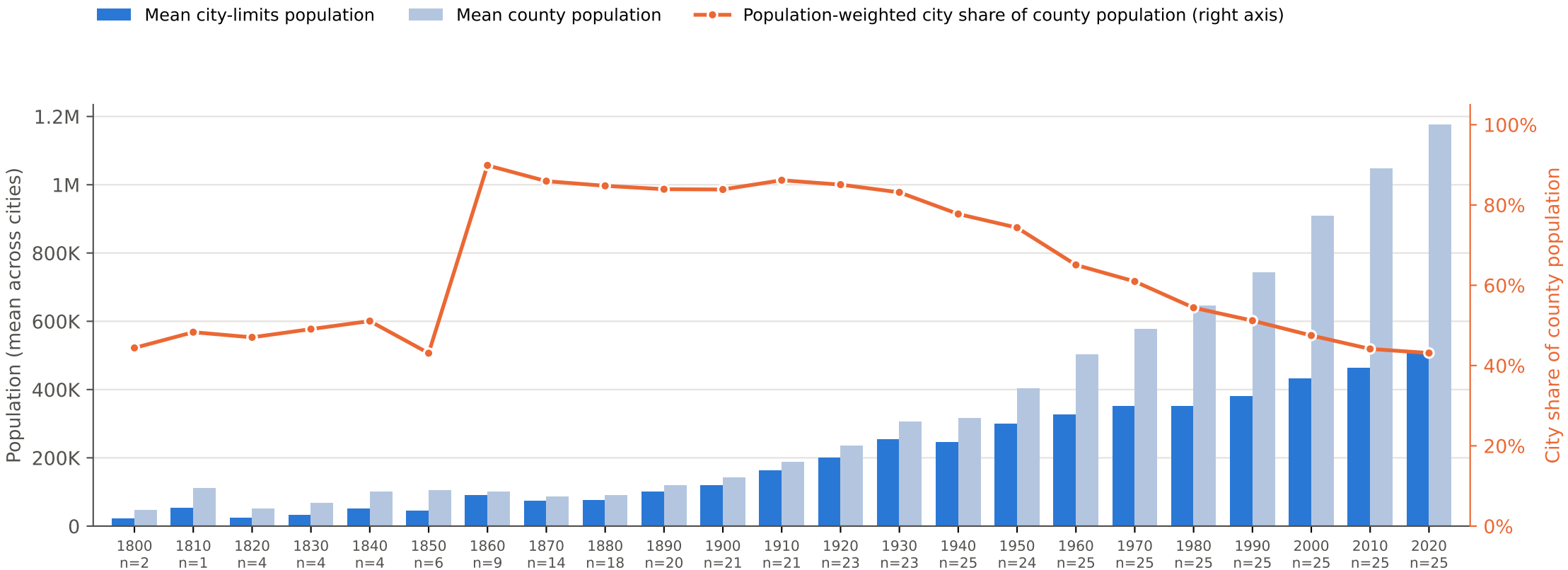
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), 25 cities with 2020 land area 110.7–195.4 sq mi. Line: simple mean of city shares.



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
Quartiles use 2020 land area for every year: they group cities by today's size, not their size at the time (many cities grew by annexation).
Land-area Q3: Philadelphia, PA, San Jose, CA, Denver, CO, Portland, OR, Las Vegas, NV, Detroit, MI, Albuquerque, NM, Fresno, CA, Mesa, AZ, Atlanta, GA, Omaha, NE, Colorado Springs, CO, Raleigh, NC, Bakersfield, CA, Wichita, KS, Aurora, CO, Tampa, FL, New Orleans, LA, Corpus Christi, TX, Greensboro, NC, Durham, NC, Fort Wayne, IN, Lubbock, TX, Winston-Salem, NC, Scottsdale, AZ.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

Land-area Q3 average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (population-weighted)

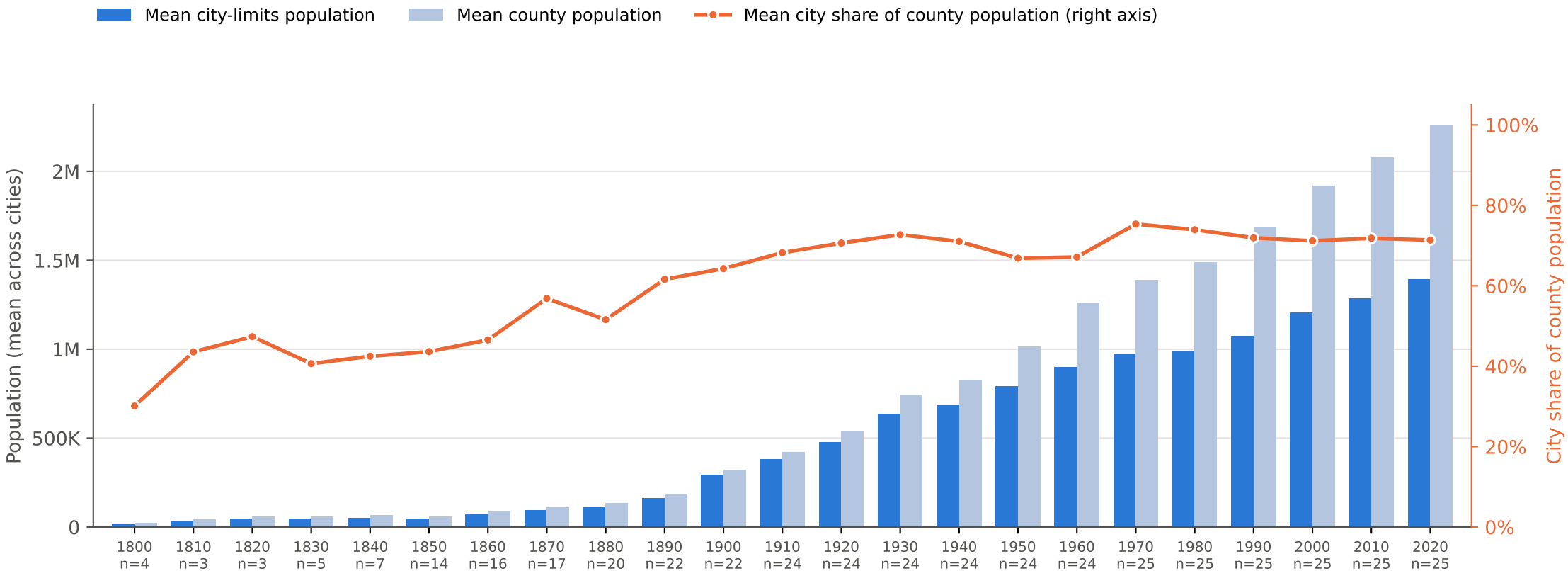
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), 25 cities with 2020 land area 110.7–195.4 sq mi. Line: total city pop. ÷ total county pop. (ratio of the bars).



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
Quartiles use 2020 land area for every year: they group cities by today's size, not their size at the time (many cities grew by annexation).
Land-area Q3: Philadelphia, PA, San Jose, CA, Denver, CO, Portland, OR, Las Vegas, NV, Detroit, MI, Albuquerque, NM, Fresno, CA, Mesa, AZ, Atlanta, GA, Omaha, NE, Colorado Springs, CO, Raleigh, NC, Bakersfield, CA, Wichita, KS, Aurora, CO, Tampa, FL, New Orleans, LA, Corpus Christi, TX, Greensboro, NC, Durham, NC, Fort Wayne, IN, Lubbock, TX, Winston-Salem, NC, Scottsdale, AZ.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

Land-area Q4 (largest) average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (unweighted)

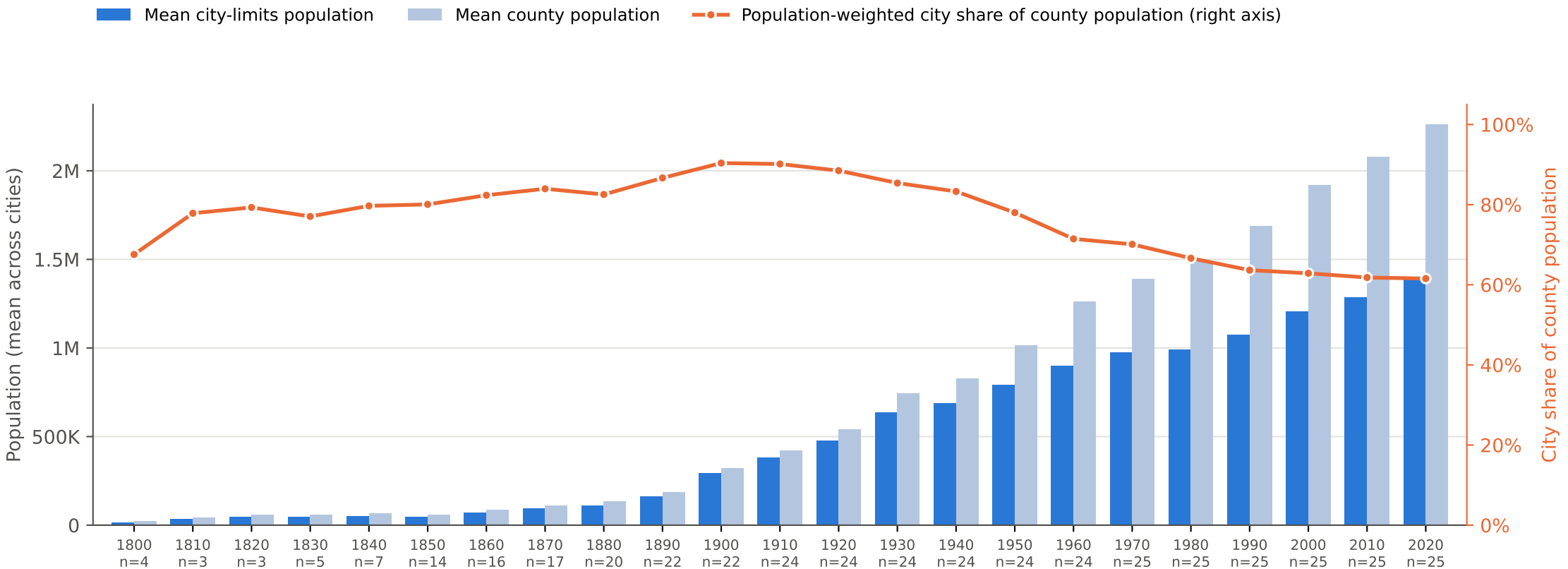
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), 25 cities with 2020 land area 197.5–747.3 sq mi. Line: simple mean of city shares.



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
Quartiles use 2020 land area for every year: they group cities by today's size, not their size at the time (many cities grew by annexation).
Land-area Q4 (largest): New York, NY, Los Angeles, CA, Chicago, IL, Houston, TX, Phoenix, AZ, San Antonio, TX, San Diego, CA, Dallas, TX, Austin, TX, Jacksonville, FL, Fort Worth, TX, Columbus, OH, Indianapolis, IN, Charlotte, NC, Nashville, TN, Oklahoma City, OK, El Paso, TX, Memphis, TN, Louisville, KY, Tucson, AZ, Kansas City, MO, Virginia Beach, VA, Tulsa, OK, Lexington, KY, Chesapeake, VA.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

Land-area Q4 (largest) average: city vs. county population, 1800–2020 (population-weighted)

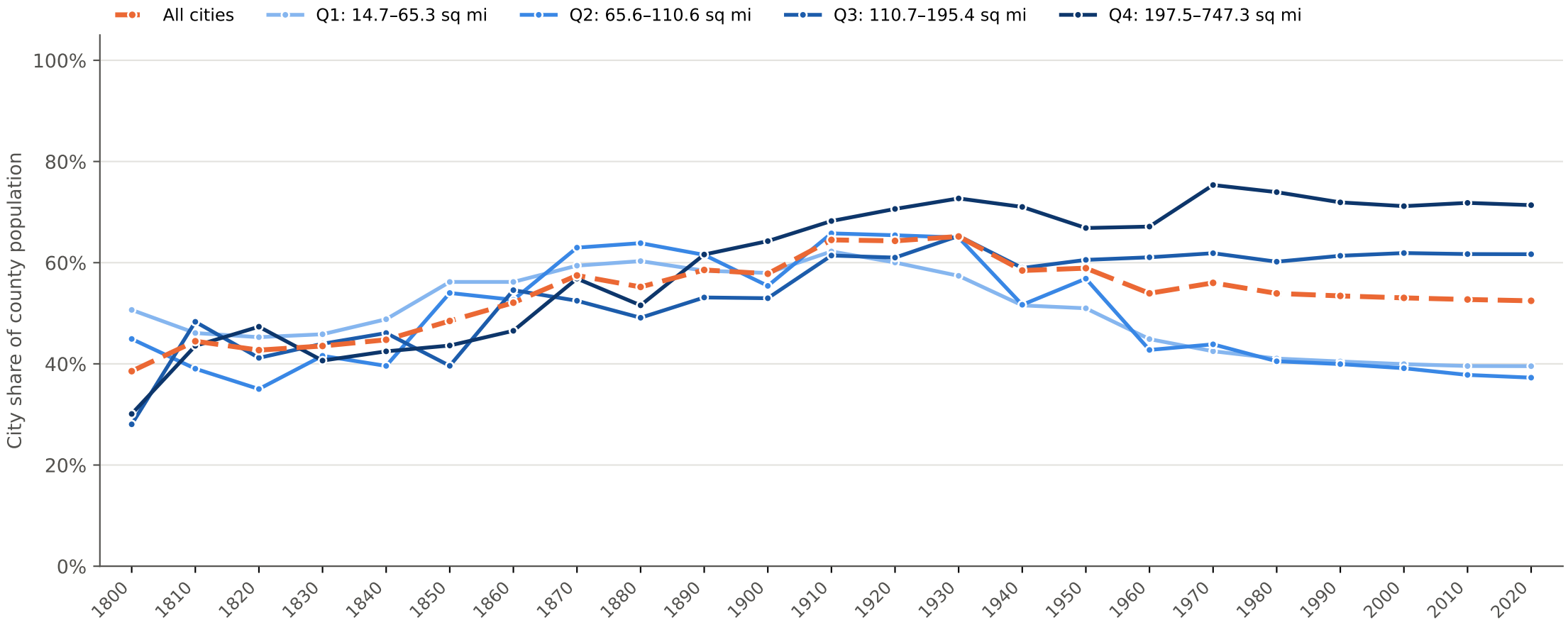
Top-100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020), 25 cities with 2020 land area 197.5–747.3 sq mi. Line: total city pop. ÷ total county pop. (ratio of the bars).



Each year averages only the cities with both a city and a county count that year (n under each year), so the sample grows over time and early years rest on few cities. Counties containing several of the cities count once per city. Consolidated city-counties (share near 100%) raise the averages.
New York's comparison area is its five boroughs (share 100%), and its size dominates this population-weighted average from 1900 on.
Quartiles use 2020 land area for every year: they group cities by today's size, not their size at the time (many cities grew by annexation).
Land-area Q4 (largest): New York, NY, Los Angeles, CA, Chicago, IL, Houston, TX, Phoenix, AZ, San Antonio, TX, San Diego, CA, Dallas, TX, Austin, TX, Jacksonville, FL, Fort Worth, TX, Columbus, OH, Indianapolis, IN, Charlotte, NC, Nashville, TN, Oklahoma City, OK, El Paso, TX, Memphis, TN, Louisville, KY, Tucson, AZ, Kansas City, MO, Virginia Beach, VA, Tulsa, OK, Lexington, KY, Chesapeake, VA.
Sources: decennial census counts (see README); city-level charts give per-city definitions and notes.

Average city share of county population: all cities and city land-area quartiles (unweighted)

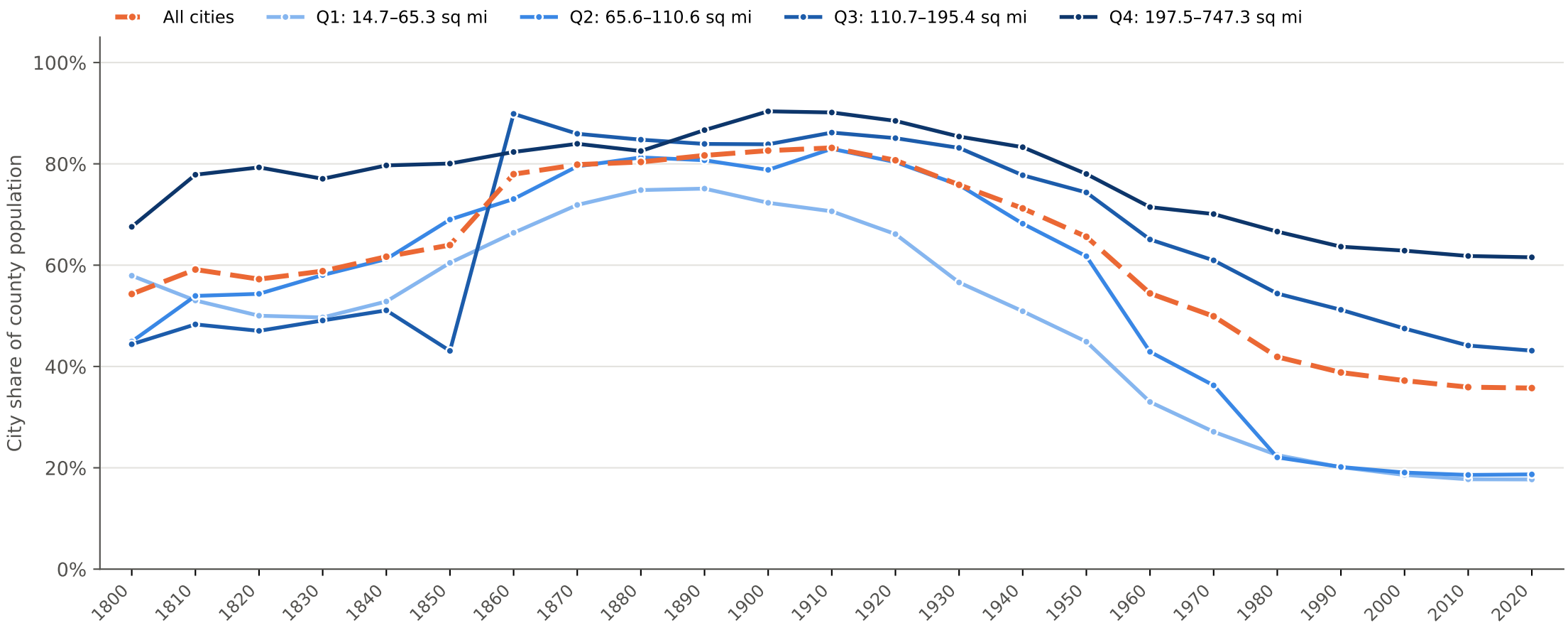
Top 100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020). Simple mean of city shares; each year uses cities with both counts.



Early years rest on few cities per group (see the n counts in the group charts). Quartiles use 2020 land area for every year. Sources: decennial census counts (see README).

Average city share of county population: all cities and city land-area quartiles (population-weighted)

Top 100 contiguous-U.S. cities (2020). Shares weighted by county population (total city ÷ total county pop.); each year uses cities with both counts.



Early years rest on few cities per group (see the n counts in the group charts). Quartiles use 2020 land area for every year. Sources: decennial census counts (see README).